

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index #
Date of filing:

-----X
T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian,
NYREE MALONE and NYREE MALONE,
individually,

Plaintiffs designate Kings County
as the place of trial

Plaintiffs,

SUMMONS

-against-

Basis of the venue is Locus of
Occurrence

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER
CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield #
5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as
yet unidentified,

Locus of Occurrence at
775 New Jersey Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11207

County of Kings

Defendants.

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TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANT:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in the case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded herein.

Defendant's address:

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

Plaintiff's attorneys:

RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
26 Court Street, Suite 1200
Brooklyn, New York 11242
(718)522-1020

POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield
5228

Tax ID # 975777

c/o New York City Police Department- 75th
Precinct

771 Miller Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11207

POLICE OFFICER CUFFY

c/o New York City Police Department- 75th
Precinct

771 Miller Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11207

Defendant's address:

POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield #
5402

Tax ID # 959975

c/o New York City Police Department- 75th
Precinct

771 Miller Avenue

Brooklyn, New York 11207

Dated: Brooklyn, New York
June 12, 2024

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X
T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian,
NYREE MALONE and NYREE MALONE,
individually,

Index No.:

COMPLAINT

Plaintiffs,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER
CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield #
5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as
yet unidentified,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiffs, by their attorneys, RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS., complaining of the
defendants herein, upon information and belief, respectfully show to this Court, and allege as
follows:

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION FOR ASSAULT
AND BATTERY ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY HIS
MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the plaintiffs were and still are residents of the County of Kings, City and State of New York.
2. That all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, was and still is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing pursuant to the laws of the State of New York.
3. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, maintains a police force known as the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.
4. That prior hereto on September 18, 2023, and within the time prescribed by law, a sworn Notice of Claim stating, among other things, the time when and place where the injuries and damages were sustained, together with plaintiff's demands for adjustment or payment thereof, was served and that thereafter THE CITY OF NEW YORK, refused or neglected for more than

(30) days and up to the commencement of this action to make any adjustment or payment thereof, and that thereafter, and within the time provided by law, this action was commenced.

5. Pursuant to the General Municipal Law, the Statutory 50-H Hearings of the plaintiffs were held on February 26, 2024.

6. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, employed POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, as police officers, agents, servants and/or employees.

7. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the infant plaintiff, T.H., was lawfully at or about the premises known as 775 New Jersey Avenue, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York.

8. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, while at the aforementioned location, the infant plaintiff, T.H. was approached and was assaulted and battered by the defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified. The assault and battery consisted of being pushed repeatedly, grabbed, had his arms twisted, slammed to the ground, struck with a knee in the back and was forcefully placed in handcuffs. Thereafter, the plaintiff was brought to the 75th Precinct, where he was held for three (3) hours and then released without being charged of a crime.

9. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, infant plaintiff, T.H., was assaulted and battered by defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at the aforesaid location.

10. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the aforementioned assault and battery was performed knowingly, intentionally and willfully.

11. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who committed the aforementioned assault and battery upon the infant plaintiff, T.H., were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

12. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the assault and battery on the plaintiff was without probable cause and was not the result of an appropriate arrest.

13. By reason of said assault and battery the plaintiff was caused to suffer severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of the person, and suffered great pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

14. By the reason of the foregoing, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENT
HIRING AND RETENTION ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY
HIS MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

15. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "14" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

16. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, did not exercise reasonable care and diligence in the selection, engagement, employment and training of their police officers, agents, servants, and employees and were negligent in the hiring, training and retention of the defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER

CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402,and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who assaulted, battered and violated the civil rights of the infant plaintiff, T.H.

17. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, had prior knowledge of the inappropriate, unlawful, and improper conduct of the defendants POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402,and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, and continued to employ them and allowed them to be in contact with the public at large.

18. By the reason of the foregoing, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION FOR FALSE
ARREST ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY HIS
MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

19. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "18" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

20. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402,and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, were working within the scope of their employment and authority with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, when they arrested and confined the infant plaintiff, T.H.

21. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the arrest and confinement was without probable cause nor based on reasonable grounds and not founded upon an arrest warrant.

22. That as a result of the aforesaid false arrest and confinement, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained serious permanent personal injuries along with humiliation, shame,

indignity, damage to reputation and credit and suffered emotional and physical distress, emotional distress and injuries.

23. By the reason of the foregoing, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR FALSE
IMPRISONMENT ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY HIS
MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

24. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1 through "23" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

25. That on July 4, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, were acting within the scope of their employment when they, without justification and without probable cause, imprisoned the infant plaintiff, T.H.

26. That the defendants, POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, while acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally confined the infant plaintiff, T.H., against his will and said confinement was not privileged.

27. By the reason of the foregoing, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR INTENTIONAL
AND NEGLIGENT INFLECTION OF EMOTIONAL
DISTRESS ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY HIS
MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

28. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above

numbered "1" through "27" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

29. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, acted intentionally, recklessly and with utter disregard to the consequences of their actions and caused severe emotional distress to the plaintiff through their actions.

30. Said actions exceeded all reasonable bounds of decency, were outrageous and shocking and resulted in severe emotional distress to the infant plaintiff, T.H.

31. That as a result of said intentional and negligent acts, the infant plaintiff, T.H., become sick, sore, lame and disabled, received severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of his person and suffered great physical pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

32. By reason of the foregoing, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR CIVIL
RIGHTS VIOLATION ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY
HIS MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

33. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "32" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

34. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through policies, practices and customs, directly caused the constitutional violation suffered by infant plaintiff, T.H.

35. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through its police department, has had and still has hiring practices that it knows will lead to the hiring of the police officers, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE

DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, lacking the intellectual capacity and moral fortitude to discharge their duties in accordance with the constitution and is indifferent to the consequences.

36. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through its police department, has *de facto quota* policy that encourages unlawful stops, unlawful searches, false arrests, the fabrication of evidence and perjury.

37. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at all relevant times, was, upon information and belief, aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, routinely commit constitutional violations such as those at issue here and has failed to change its policies, practices and customs to stop this behavior.

38. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at all relevant times, was aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, are unfit officers who have previously committed the acts alleged herein and/or have a propensity for unconstitutional conduct.

39. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR
PUNITIVE DAMAGES ON BEHALF OF T.H., AN INFANT BY
HIS MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN, NYREE MALONE**

40. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "39" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

41. The actions of the defendants herein-above alleged, were malicious, willful and grossly negligent.

42. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, authorized, permitted and ratified the unlawful and negligent acts of their agents, servants and/or employees, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER JOANNA ROMANO-Shield # 5228, POLICE OFFICER CUFFY, POLICE SERGEANT JEFFREY LIU-Shield # 5402, and JOHN AND JANE DOES- Police Officers as yet unidentified, herein-above alleged.

43. By the reason of the foregoing, the infant plaintiff, T.H., sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR AN EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR LOSS OF
SERVICES ON BEHALF OF NYREE MALONE, AS
MOTHER AND NATURAL GUARDIAN OF THE INFANT, T.H.**

44. The plaintiffs repeat and reallege each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "43" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

45. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the plaintiff, NYREE MALONE, was the lawful Mother and Natural Guardian of the infant plaintiff, T.H., and as such said plaintiff, NYREE MALONE, was entitled to the society and services of said infant plaintiff, T.H.

46. By reason of the afore-described negligence of defendants, the plaintiff, NYREE MALONE, was deprived of the society and services of the infant plaintiff, T.H., and shall forever be deprived of said society and services.

47. As a result of herein above, plaintiff, NYREE MALONE, has expended diverse sums of money in payment of the expenses incurred for medical care, treatment and hospitalization for infant plaintiff, T.H.

48. That by reason of the foregoing negligence on the part of the defendants, the plaintiff, NYREE MALONE, has been damaged in a sum exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts.

WHEREFORE plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **First Cause** of Action; plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Second Cause** of Action; plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Third Cause** of Action; plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Fourth Cause** of Action; plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Fifth Cause** of Action; plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Sixth Cause** of Action; plaintiff, T.H., an infant by his Mother and Natural Guardian, NYREE MALONE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Seventh Cause** of Action; plaintiff, NYREE MALONE, Mother and Natural Guardian of the infant plaintiff, T.H., demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts, on the **Eighth Cause** of Action; together with attorneys' fees, and the costs and disbursements of this action.

DATED: Brooklyn, New York
June 12, 2024

Yours, etc., 

ROBERT MIJUCA, ESQ.
RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
Attorneys for Plaintiffs
26 Court Street Suite 1200
Brooklyn, New York 11242
(718) 522-1020
File No.: 23TH07-04

INDIVIDUAL VERIFICATION

STATE OF NEW YORK)

) SS:

COUNTY OF KINGS)

NYREE MALONE, being duly sworn, deposes and says, that deponent is the Mother and Natural Guardian of the infant plaintiff, T.H., in the within action; that deponent has read the foregoing COMPLAINT and knows the contents hereof; that the same is true to deponent's own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to those matters deponent believes them to be true.



NYREE MALONE

Sworn to before me this 17th
day of June 2024



NOTARY PUBLIC

MAGDA MARIN-COLON
Notary Public, State of New York
No. 01MA6158891
Qualified in Richmond County
Commission Expires 1-16-20 